NNN-D-335B
September 24, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec.
NNN-D-00335a (VA)
May 21, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DISH, CULTURE, PETRI, STERILE, PLASTIC, DISPOSABLE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one size of sterile, plastic, disposable Petri culture dish consisting of both top (cover) section and bottom section. The bottom section may be uncompartmented, two-sectional and three-sectional, as specified. The top (cover) section shall be a single design. The size of the Petri culture dish is commercially referred to as 100 x 15.

1.2 Classification. Bottoms shall be of the following types and classes (see 6.2):

Type I - Uncompartmented
Type II - Compartmented

Class 1 - Bisected
Class 2 - Trisected

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration, Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-S-36586 - Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare:

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

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U. S. Pharmacoepeial Convention, Inc.

Pharmacoepeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The Petri dish shall be fabricated from polystyrene that shall be clear and transparent, and free of toxic lubricants and other additives which would adversely affect the growth of bacterial cultures.

3.2 Design and construction. The design and dimensions of the Petri dish shall be in accordance with the figures listed in table I. Minor variations in design shall be accepted provided they do not conflict with dimensional or configurational limitations indicated in the figures.

Table I

Petri dish		Figure
Type	Class	
I	-	1
II	1	2
III	2	3

The bottom section shall be constructed so that it sits flat on a plane and level surface and provides for a uniform media depth. The top section shall fit over and shall be easily removed from the bottom section by using one hand.

3.2.1 Writing surface. Provisions for marking the outside surface of the Petri dish shall be provided by the contractor in accordance with either of the following:

a. A roughened or frosted area on the top section so that markings by pencil, ink or crayon may be easily applied (see applicable figure).

b. The surfaces of the Petri dish are suitable to accept clear and clean marking with a wax- or crayon-type pencil.

3.3 Sterility. The Petri dish shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.1.

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3.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the procuring activity (see 6.3), and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.3.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s). In addition, each bag of dishes shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number as specified in 5.3.2.1.

3.4 Identification marking. The manufacturer's name or registered trademark shall be permanently and legibly marked on the outside of the top or bottom or both sections of the individual Petri dish. Manufacturer's identification marking shall be located in positions that will not interfere with studies of the culture.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The Petri dish shall be supplied clean and dry, and shall be free of defects which may impair serviceability or detract from its appearance. The Petri dish shall be free

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of cracks, breaks, chips, sharp edges and deformation. The plastic material shall be optically clear, except for the marking area as indicated in 3.2.1. The Petri dish shall be sufficiently scratch-free so as not to interfere with the studies of the culture. Mold marks and manufacturer's identification markings on the Petri dish shall be located in positions that will not interfere with studies of the culture. The unit container for the Petri dish (see 5.1.1.1) shall be free of cuts, tears and pinholes.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be the individual Petri dish or unit container (see 5.1.1.1) as indicated in 4.3.1 and 4.3.3. Not more than 10 individual Petri dishes shall be selected from a unit container. All samples shall be randomly selected.

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Table II For sampling

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Minor defects	II	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-2	2.5
For count	S-2	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with requirements of 4.4.1 for compliance with 3.3. The acceptance number shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The Petri dishes shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with table III. Examination shall not be restricted to the possible defects listed in the table.

Table III Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
A. Unit of product - Petri dish	
Major	
101	Petri dish not free of cracks.
102	Petri dish not free of breaks.
103	Petri dish not free of chips.
104	Petri dish not free of sharp edges.
105	Markings not easily applied on top section surface.
106	Petri dish not clean or dry.
107	Petri dish not properly assembled.
108	Petri dish not free of deformation.
109	Petri dish not free of crazing, which impedes functional usage.
110	Petri dish not transparent or not clear within functional requirement of usage.
111	Removal or replacement of top section not easily accomplished with one hand.

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Classification of defects (cont'd)

Categories	Defects
Minor	
201	Identification marking not legible, complete or correct.
202	Petri dish not free of burrs and flashes.
203	Petri dish not free of pits, scratches and abrasions which impair visibility in normal usage.
204	Petri dish not free of embedded foreign material.
205	Petri dish not free of loose plastic particles or other foreign material.
B. Unit of product - Unit container (see 5.1.1.1)	
Major	
301	Bag not properly sealed to maintain sterility of contents.
302	Bag not free of cuts, tears, pinholes or openings.
Minor	
401	Required marking (see 5.3.2.1) not present or legible.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The Petri dish shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within specified limits shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3 Count. The contents of a unit container (see 5.1.1.1) shall be checked for a sufficient quantity of Petri dishes. Any container (bag) not containing at least 20 Petri dishes shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging and marking requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of shipping containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 percent defective.

Table IV Examination of preparation for delivery

Container	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Packaging and packing materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers. Cushioning inadequate or improper.

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4.3.5 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding of containers. When unit packages are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing or banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Sterility test. Petri dishes shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the U.S.P. Procedural Details for Sterility Tests for Non-Parenteral Devices, using inoculated product or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization, including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be S-3 in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Unless otherwise specified, the product for testing purposes shall be that quantity of Petri dishes that will be supplied in the exterior container (see 5.2).

4.4.1.1 Inoculated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of sterilization	Organism	Incubation temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55°- 65°C.
Dry heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55°- 65°C.
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30°- 35°C.
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30°- 35°C.
Radiation	B. pumilus	30°- 35°C.

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance to spore populations included in MIL-S-36586. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.1 and 4.4.1.1. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.1.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the U.S.P.

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4.4.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the contracting officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a Government contract.

4.4.1.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator in accordance with the U.S.P.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit container. Twenty dishes shall be packaged in a heat-sealed plastic bag of appropriate size. The bag shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. As an alternate, the bag may be a sealed combination plastic and sterilizable paper or equal, capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened.

5.1.2 Level C. Dishes shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, to maintain sterility and which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified, 25 unit containers shall be packed in an exterior container constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. The box shall be provided with chipboard or fiberboard dividers. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified, 25 unit containers shall be packed in an exterior container having a minimum bursting strength of 175 pounds and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. The box shall be provided with chipboard or fiberboard dividers. Closure of the box shall be as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers to

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point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities.

5.3.2.1 Unit container. In addition to any commercial markings, each bag shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. In addition, marking shall include the legend: "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED" or similar statement and sterility lot (control) number. Marking shall be printed directly on the bag or on an insert placed within the bag in such a manner as to permit ready identification.

5.3.2.2 Exterior container. Each box shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 as required for the exterior container. Lot (control) number and the legend "STERILE" shall also be shown. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry heat sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging (Example: A-1/73-G). Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date. In addition, the quantity and unit of issue shall be shown as "1 PG" and not "500 dishes."

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The Petri dishes are intended for use in performing bacteriological cultures and biological assays.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type and class required (see 1.2).
c. When certificate of sterility is not to be forwarded to the Defense Personnel Support Center (see 6.3).
d. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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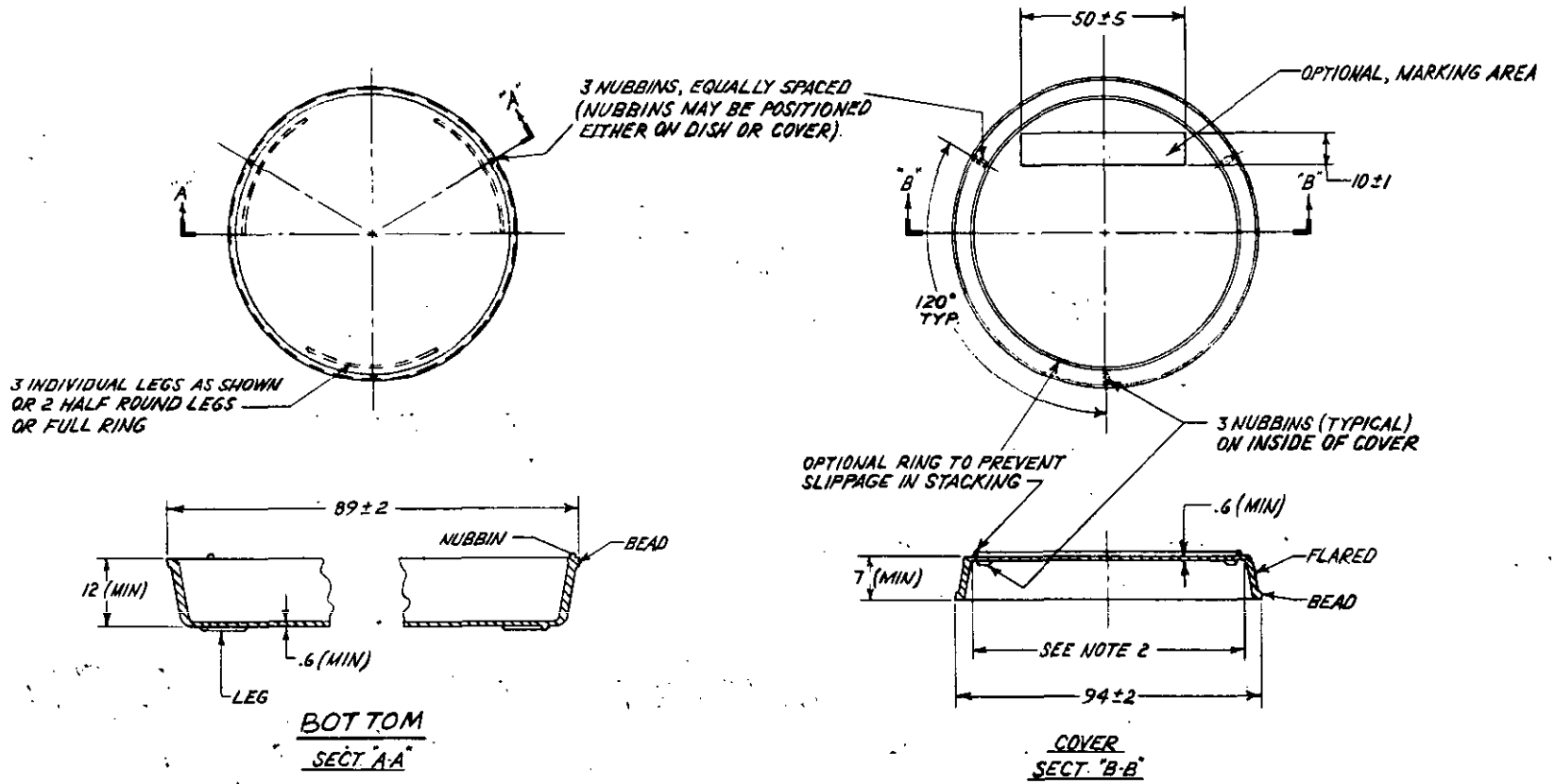


FIGURE 1

TYPE I, UNCOMPARTMENTED PETRI DISH

NOTES:-

1. ALL DIMENSIONS IN MILLIMETERS (MM).
2. DIAMETER OF CIRCULAR SURFACE TO PROVIDE CLEARANCE WITH OUTSIDE RIM OF DISH.
3. DO NOT SCALE DIMENSIONS.

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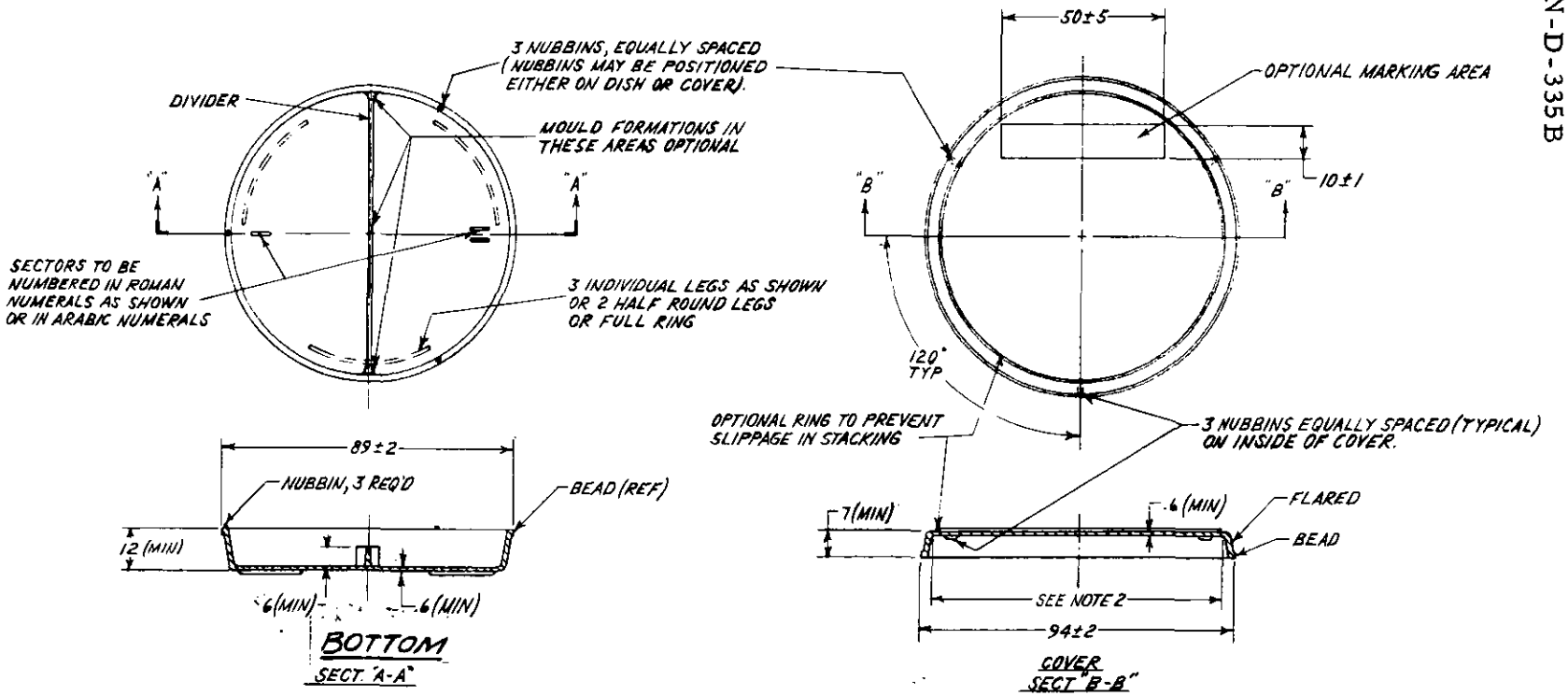


FIGURE 2
BISECTED PETRI DISH
TYPE II & CLASS I

NOTES
1. ALL DIMENSIONS IN MILLIMETERS (MM)
2. DIAMETER OF CIRCULAR SURFACE TO PROVIDE CLEARANCE WITH OUTSIDE RIM OF DISH.
3. DO NOT SCALE DIMENSIONS.

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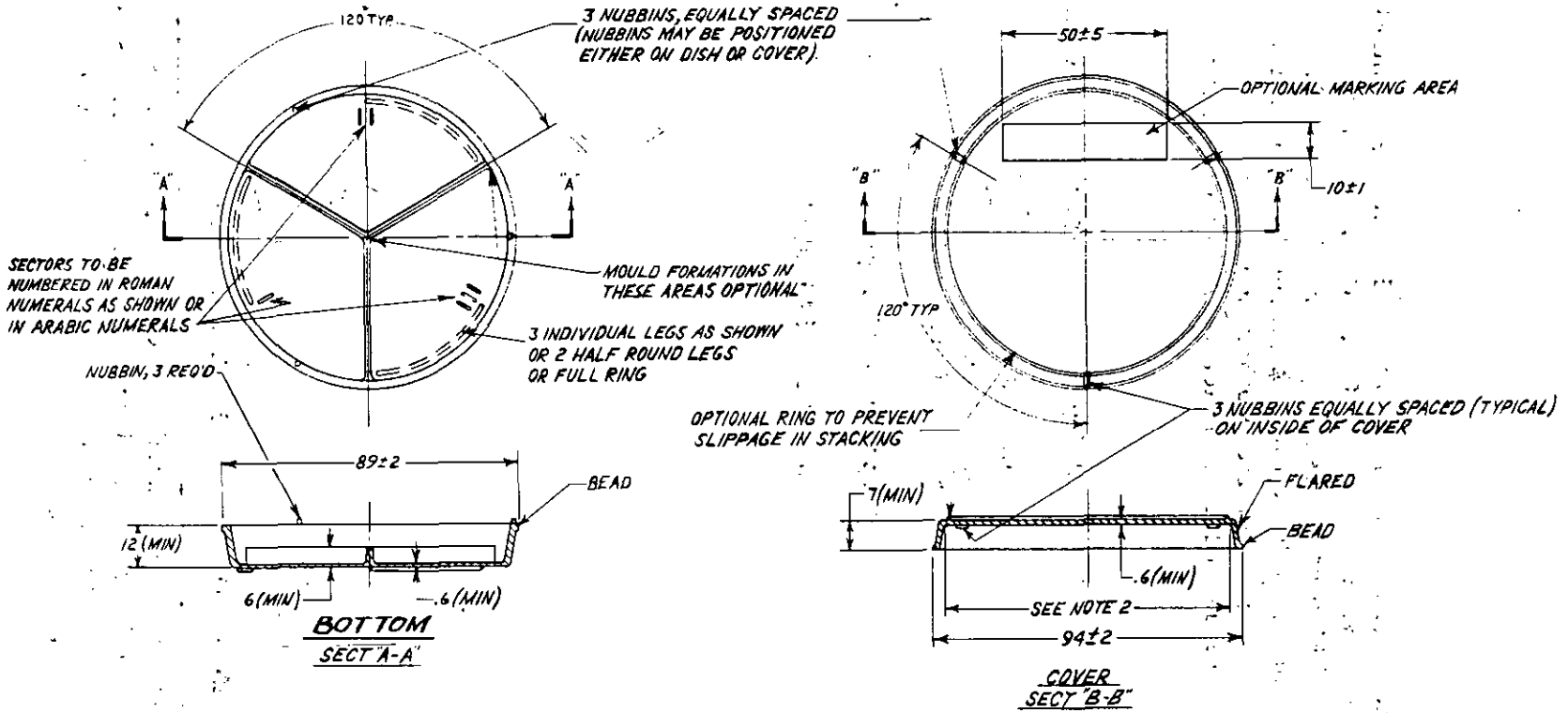


FIGURE 3
TRISECTED PETRI DISH
TYPE II & CLASS 2

NOTES:
1. ALL DIMENSIONS IN MILLIMETERS (MM)
2. DIAMETER OF CIRCULAR SURFACE TO PROVIDE CLEARANCE WITH OUTSIDE RIM OF DISH.
3. DO NOT SCALE DIMENSIONS.

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6.3 For military procurements originating from the Defense Personnel Support Center, Philadelphia, PA, certificates of sterility are to be forwarded to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101. For procurements originating from other agencies, the certificates of sterility shall be forwarded as indicated by the contracting officer (see 3.3.1).

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA - FSS
VA - DMS
HEW - NIH

Preparing activity: DSA - DM

Project No. 6640-0911

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

NNN-D-335B Dish, Culture, Petri, Sterile, Plastic, Disposable

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

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A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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